



The Woman Who Held On to Hope

A Memoir



BY

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Dedication

I dedicate this book to my mother;

*A woman whom life tried many times to break, but
every time, with a wounded heart and tired hands,
she stood up again.*

*A woman who never had the chance to truly
experience her own childhood, yet taught her
children how to remain hopeful.*

*A woman who silently endured countless pains,
but never allowed kindness to leave her heart.*

My dear mother...

*These pages cannot fully describe all your
suffering, your patience, your tears, and your love;
but my attempt is to become the voice of a woman
who fought for years without anyone knowing her
story.*



Foreword

SOME LIVES ARE NOT simply a collection of days and years; some lives are stories that deserve to be heard.

Stories of patience, love, sacrifice, and hope.

Stories of people who may have lived ordinary lives among others, but carried a great heroism within their hearts.

"The Woman Who Held On to Hope" is the story of a woman whose path was never smooth.

A woman who faced hardships, endured deep pain, lost beloved people, and lived through days whose true weight of suffering perhaps no one could understand.

But despite everything that happened to her, she never allowed the darkness to extinguish the light inside her heart.

She held on to hope.

This book is not only about sorrow and difficulties.

It is about the strength of a mother; a mother who stood firm when life became unbearable.

It is about a woman who silently carried many of her pains so that her family could have peace.

It is about a heart that was broken, yet still had the ability to love.

Life taught her that being strong does not mean living without pain.

Being strong means rising again despite the tears.

It means continuing for the people you love even when you are exhausted.

It means preserving your humanity and kindness even on the hardest days.

Perhaps, within these pages, many mothers will find pieces of themselves.

Perhaps those who have suffered will understand that they are not alone.

And perhaps those who have experienced a mother's love will value this endless love even more.

This story reminds us that every person carries a hidden story.

We do not always know the battles others are fighting inside their hearts.

So we must look with more kindness, listen more deeply, and appreciate more those who have quietly struggled for us.

I hope this book is not only a story;

I hope it becomes a small light for those searching for hope in the middle of life's hardships.

Because sometimes one person, with a kind heart, can change the lives of others.

This book is dedicated to all mothers who fought silently;

To all hearts that suffered but chose love;

And to all those who held on to hope, even when
surrender seemed like the easiest choice.



Introduction

SOME LIVES ARE NOT like stories.

They are so difficult that if someone watched them in a movie, they might not believe they were real.

But somewhere in this world, among the mountains and plains of Afghanistan, a girl lived whose destiny was filled with events that no child should ever have to experience.

A girl who was born one day in a beautiful and green village; a place where the sound of water, the songs of birds, and the scent of earth were part of people's everyday lives.

She did not know that one day she would have to face the greatest pains of life.

She did not know that she would have to grow up far earlier than she should.

She did not know that there would come days when the only reason she would rise from the ground would be her love for her children.

But there was one thing she carried with her from childhood:

Hope.

A hope that came from her parents' prayers.

A hope that came from her faith in God.

And a hope that would later become a lamp for her entire family.

This is not the story of an ordinary woman.

This is the story of a woman who remained human during the hardest days.

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CHAPTER ONE

The Girl Who Brightened the Home With Her Arrival



YEAR 1353.

It was a peaceful morning.

The sun was slowly rising from behind the mountains.

A cool breeze passed through the green trees of the village, and the songs of birds blended with the sounds of people's daily lives.

The village was small, but beautiful.

The houses were simple; mud walls, small yards, and gardens that people cared for with great effort.

In one of those houses, a family was waiting for the arrival of a child.

The father of the family was a hardworking man.

A simple farmer, but a man with a great heart.

An honest, wise, and kind man whom the people of the village respected.

The mother of the family was a calm and gentle woman.

Their home may not have been large, but it was full of love.

That day, when the cry of a newborn baby filled the house, no one knew how much this little girl would change their lives.

She was born.

A small girl.

But her arrival was like the arrival of light for the family.

After her birth, the family's circumstances improved.

Their work flourished.

More blessings entered their home.

And her father, who had always wished for a beloved child, did not see his daughter as just a child.

He saw her as his friend.

His keeper of secrets.

Someone to whom he would one day entrust his entire heart.

When her father held her in his arms, it felt as if all the tiredness of his days disappeared.

In her father's embrace, the little girl felt that the safest place in the world was right there.

Years later, when hardships began, these small memories would be what kept her alive.

Her childhood passed peacefully.

She was a quiet, shy, and kind girl.

A child whose presence brought warmth without needing many words.

People smiled when they heard her name, because they knew her as a respectful and good-hearted girl.

She was the kind of child who, when entering a place, created a feeling of comfort without saying many words.

People smiled whenever they heard her name, because they knew her as a modest and good-hearted girl.

She did not go to school.

Not because she had no interest in learning.

But because, at that time, circumstances were such that many girls did not have the opportunity to attend school.

For girls in that society, leaving the home was not easy.

However, she learned many things at home.

From her mother, she learned:

Patience.

Kindness.

Hard work.

From her father, she learned:

Honesty.

Wisdom.

Respect for others.

And among all the people in her life, there was one person who held a special place in her heart.

Her brother.

He was not only her brother.

He was her friend.

Her childhood companion.

The person who made her early years sweeter.

He never once told her:

"You are a girl. You cannot play."

To him, his sister was simply a child.

A child who had the right to laugh.

The right to play.

The right to be happy.

But no one knew that these peaceful days would end much sooner than anyone imagined.

No one knew that the little girl who was playing peacefully in the yard of her home would one day have to carry a heavy burden on her small shoulders.

The camera of life was still focused on her smiles.

But slowly, the real story of her life was beginning.

CHAPTER TWO

The Last Days of Childhood



HER CHILDHOOD WAS PEACEFUL.

So peaceful that no one could imagine that one day this peace would become a distant memory.

Every morning, she woke up to the sound of her mother's voice.

The smell of fresh bread, the sound of her father walking in the yard, the sounds of animals, and the laughter of childhood---all of these meant home to her.

A small home, but full of love.

She did not yet know that sometimes people possess the greatest treasures of their lives at the very moment they believe life is ordinary.

For her, those days were ordinary.

But years later, every one of those moments became her most precious memories.

Whenever her father returned from outside, his daughter was always the first person to welcome him.

When she heard his footsteps, she would happily run toward the door.

She would throw herself into his arms.

And in that moment, she felt that no power in the world could ever harm her.

When she sat in her father's arms, she felt like the little queen of that home.

She had no fear.

No worries.

Because she had a father behind her.

A man who always told her:

"Be patient. Treat people kindly. Never lie. Never wrong anyone. And never desire what belongs to others."

Her mother was another beautiful world for her.

A gentle and loving woman who knew how to show affection.

Her mother's hands meant safety.

Whenever she felt sad, her mother's embrace made everything better.

From her mother, she learned that a woman can remain kind even while facing hardships.

At that time, she did not know that these lessons would one day become the greatest treasures of her life.

Among all her childhood memories, one person always held a special place.

Her brother.

Her brother was not just a few years older than her; he was like a little father to her.

When she played with him, the world felt complete.

They laughed together.

They played childhood games.

They ran through the village paths.

At that time, no one had told her that because she was a girl, she should be deprived of the happiness of childhood.

She was simply a child.

And her brother allowed her to remain a child.

One day, when her brother returned from a trip to Iran, he brought her gifts.

A necklace and a ring.

To others, they may have been simple gifts.

But to that little girl, their value was greater than anything else in the world.

She took them and looked at her brother with eyes full of happiness.

For her, those gifts were not just gold and jewelry.

They were a sign that there was someone in this world who thought about her.

Someone who loved her.

Her parents always taught her to be a good person.

They would say:

"Be patient."

"Do not be arrogant."

"Respect others."

"Do not allow everyone into your life."

"Be trustworthy."

"Never forget God."

She listened to all these words with her innocent child's heart.

But no one knew that one day she would need every one of these lessons in order to survive.

The years of childhood passed.

She grew older.

But inside her heart, she was still the same quiet and shy girl.

A girl who spent most of her time with her mother at home.

She helped with household tasks.

She learned sewing.

And she lived her simple but sweet life.

But beyond the walls of that home, there was a society where many decisions about girls' lives were made for them.

Decisions that were sometimes made without anyone listening to the girl's own voice.

And slowly, whispers began.

Whispers about marriage.

About how a girl should leave her father's home sooner.

About traditions that no one had dared to question for years.

She was still a child.

She was still happy with dolls and childhood games.

She still saw the world as something simple.

She still believed growing up meant wearing beautiful clothes and receiving gifts.

She did not know that some beautiful clothes hide heavy responsibilities behind them.

The day came when guests arrived to see her.

Guests who were going to change the path of her life.

Everyone spoke about the goodness of that young man.

About his family.

About his character.

Her parents were happy.

Because they believed perhaps a good future was waiting for their daughter.

But one person was not happy.

The same brother who had always been beside her.

The same person who knew her better than anyone else.

He knew this girl was still too young for such a decision.

He knew her childhood was not finished yet.

But his voice disappeared among the traditions and customs of society.

\...And that day,
without the little girl knowing,
the first page of the difficult chapter of her life
was written.

CHAPTER THREE

The Girl Who Wore a Wedding Dress, But Was Still a Child



THE DAY WHEN THE family first spoke about her marriage, she still did not understand the true meaning of marriage.

She only knew what she saw through the eyes of a child:

Beautiful clothes.

Bright colors.

Gifts.

A celebration.

And the fact that everyone paid attention to the bride.

For a child, marriage looked like a big celebration.

Not a great responsibility.

Not a new life.

Not a separation from the home that had been her entire world.

At that time, in that village, there were traditions that no one had questioned for years.

Girls were expected to marry at a young age.

When a child lost her baby teeth, some people would say:

"This girl has grown up now. We should think about her future."

But no one asked:

Is this child's heart ready?

Does she understand what a shared life means?

Does she still have the right to be a child?

When her father heard about the proposal, he only saw the good qualities of that young man.

He knew the boy was not a bad person.

He knew his family was respected.

And in the society where they lived, these things seemed enough to accept a marriage.

Perhaps he did not want his daughter to be unhappy.

Perhaps he believed he was making the best decision for her future.

But no one knew what the future had hidden.

When the news of her engagement came, the house became full of visitors.

Everyone was happy.

Everyone smiled.

Everyone was making plans for the future of the little girl of the family.

But in one corner of the house, someone remained silent.

Her brother.

The same person who had always been beside her since childhood.

He understood more than anyone that this girl was still a child.

He saw that his sister still looked at the world with the same innocent and pure eyes.

That was why he did not want her to be separated from the home where she had grown up.

But the decision had already been made.

The little girl became engaged.

While she still knew so little about life.

During the two years of engagement, the young man sometimes came to their home.

He treated her kindly.

He behaved with affection.

He tried to help the little girl become comfortable with his presence.

He respected her.

And because of this, she did not feel a great amount of fear.

But what no one thought about was this:

A person being good does not always mean that a child is ready for marriage.

Sometimes the problem is not the people.

Sometimes the problem is the timing.

Two years passed.

The girl turned ten years old.

The day came when she was supposed to leave her father's home.

The day everyone had prepared for.

She wore new clothes.

Her hands were decorated with henna.

She wore beautiful fabrics.

The sound of happiness and music filled the house.

People from the village came.

Relatives gathered.

Everything looked like a great celebration.

Everything looked like a great celebration.

She smiled too.

Not because she fully understood the truth of what was happening,

but because she was still a child.

To her, this day seemed like an exciting event.

She thought a new life meant new clothes, a new home, and new people.

She did not yet know that life sometimes takes things away from a person that no beautiful dress can ever replace.

Among all that happiness, one person was crying.

Her brother.

The same brother who had always loved her.

He knew that this departure was not only leaving one home.

It was the end of an era.

The end of the days when his sister could play without fear.

The end of the days when she was simply a child.

The mother who prepared her daughter for that journey perhaps carried thousands of thoughts in her heart.

She was happy that her daughter was marrying a good person.

But deep inside, there was also a small worry.

Mothers often feel parts of the future with their hearts.

The little girl looked at her home one last time.

At the walls where she had grown up.

At the yard where she had played.

At the place where she had always felt safe.

She left.

With a small heart.

With a world full of unknowns.

And with the memory of her father's embrace, which she had always believed would be her forever shelter.

But her new life, unlike what a child imagines, was not only beautiful clothes and days of celebration.

Behind the doors of her new home, another

chapter of her story was waiting.

A chapter in which she would have to grow up far too quickly.

CHAPTER FOUR

The Short Years of Childhood, The Heavy Years of Responsibility



AT FIRST, LIFE WAS not as frightening as she might have imagined.

Her husband was kind to her.

He knew that his wife was still a child.

He even reminded his family:

"She is still young. Do not expect heavy responsibilities from her."

For a while, that girl felt that perhaps her new life could also be peaceful.

She still missed her father's home.

She missed her mother.

Her father.

Her brother.

She missed those days when her only responsibility was to play.

But every time her brother or her parents came to visit her, her heart became calmer.

One year and a half passed.

She slowly became used to her new home.

Slowly, she learned how to be a wife.

But inside her, the same little girl still existed.

The girl who did not know that the greatest tests of her life were approaching.

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And then,

the day came when life showed its harsh face for the first time.

The day when a twelve-year-old child was forced to carry a pain that would be heavy even for an adult.

\...

The day when she became a mother.

And her journey of motherhood began with a deep sorrow.

CHAPTER FIVE

The First Time Life Revealed Its True Face



SHE WAS TWELVE YEARS old.

An age when a child should still be chasing games,

laughing with friends,

and finding happiness in small things.

But life had chosen a different path for her.

She was now a mother.

A girl who still needed her own mother's love had now become the mother of a child who would become all her hope and love.

When her baby was born, perhaps for the first time after her marriage, her heart tasted a great happiness.

That child was not only her baby.

The child was a sign that perhaps life could smile at her again.

She cared for her baby with her small hands.

She watched him.

She listened to his peaceful breaths.

And perhaps, deep inside her heart, she wished:

"My God, please do not take this one away from me."

\...

But three months later,
something happened that no mother is ever
ready to hear.

She lost her child.

Not because of a lack of love.

Not because of a lack of care.

But because of the inexperience and the difficult
circumstances in which a twelve-year-old child had
been placed.

She still did not know how to face all the
challenges of motherhood.

There was no one there to hold her hand and
teach her.

The death of that child became the first great
wound in her heart.

But she still did not know that greater pains
were waiting ahead.

She was just beginning to live with the absence
of her child when, three months later,
fate struck again.

\...

Her husband.

The young man she loved.

The man who had tried to protect her during the
early days of their marriage.

The man who was only twenty years old.

He had to leave for two years of military service, a law that existed for many young men at that time.

No one thought that this departure would be his final goodbye.

War and insecurity had changed the lives of many families.

And during those difficult days, terrible news arrived.

Her young husband had been killed.

Killed by opponents of the government of that time.

\...

A twelve-year-old girl.

Within only three months, she had lost both her child and her husband.

The two people who were her entire little world.

Many people at that age could not even fully understand the meaning of death.

But she was forced to understand.

She was forced to live with the empty spaces left by two beloved people.

The home where she had once entered with hope was now filled with memories.

Every corner reminded her of something.

The place where her baby had slept.

The place where her husband had sat.

The place where laughter once existed but

would never return.

But her pain was not only about losing them.

After her husband's death, another problem began.

Her husband's family did not want to lose this young and beautiful girl.

They wanted her to marry her husband's brother.

But her heart could not accept it.

Not because she did not want to live.

But because she did not want to betray the husband she had lost.

She was still a child.

Yet inside her was something greater than her age.

A conscience.

Loyalty.

And respect for the short life she had shared with her husband.

She did not want to take the place of another woman.

She did not want to hurt someone who might one day become that man's wife.

But refusing was not easy.

She was in a home where she had little power to make decisions.

The pressure increased.

The conversations increased.

But this time, the little girl decided to become the voice of her own heart.

She cried.

She insisted.

She told her father:

"I do not want to marry him."

\...

Her father,

the same man who had always been her shelter, listened to his daughter.

He understood her pain.

He knew this child had endured more than anyone should have to endure.

And for the first time after a long while, he stood beside his daughter again.

With great difficulty, he helped her leave that home.

Her husband's family, hurt and angry, returned her to her father with only a few pieces of clothing.

But for that girl, returning to her father's home was not simply returning to a place.

It was returning to the last safe place left in her life.

She returned to her father's home.

The same home where she had once lived as a happy child.

But she was no longer the same girl who had left that house years before.

She had left as a child.

She returned carrying a lifetime of pain.

She had lost her child.

She had lost her husband.

She had lost the simple happiness that belonged to her childhood.

But despite all of this, one thing was still alive inside her:

The desire to continue living.

Her father looked at his daughter and saw a pain that no father wanted to see.

A young girl who should have been thinking about games and dreams was now carrying memories that belonged to an old person.

He felt guilty.

He wondered whether he could have protected her more.

Whether he could have given her more time.

Whether he could have stopped the events that changed her life forever.

But some things in life cannot be returned.

Some wounds cannot be erased.

They can only be carried.

And she had to learn how to carry them.

At her father's home, she slowly began to heal.

Her mother stayed close to her.

She held her daughter's hand.

She listened to her tears.

She did not have the power to bring back what had been lost.

But she gave her something that was sometimes more important:

A place where she could cry without fear.

A place where she could be weak for a while.

A place where she did not have to pretend to be strong.

Days passed.

The pain did not disappear.

But slowly, the girl began to understand something:

Life had taken many things away from her,
but it had not taken away her ability to stand again.

She was still alive.

And as long as she was alive, there was still a possibility for a new beginning.

CHAPTER SIX

Returning to Life



AFTER RETURNING TO HER father's home, she spent many days in silence.

There were moments when she looked at the world around her and wondered:

"Why did this happen to me?"

She was only twelve years old.

A child who had barely understood the meaning of marriage,

and yet she had already experienced separation, loss, and grief.

Sometimes at night, when everyone was asleep, she cried quietly.

She remembered her baby.

She remembered her husband.

She remembered the days when she believed her life would continue peacefully.

But every morning, when the sun rose, life reminded her that she had to continue.

Her parents tried to bring happiness back into her heart.

Her father treated her with even more love than before.

He wanted his daughter to forget the painful days.

But some memories do not disappear.

They become a part of a person.

Over time, she became stronger.

Not because the pain became smaller,

but because her heart became bigger.

She learned that a person can carry sadness and still smile.

A person can lose something precious and still find a reason to continue.

And perhaps the greatest lesson she learned was this:

Life does not always ask us whether we are ready for its challenges.

Sometimes it simply places a heavy burden on our shoulders.

And then we discover a strength inside ourselves that we never knew existed.

She was no longer only the little girl who had once played in her father's yard.

She had become a young woman who had faced storms and survived.

But fate was not finished writing her story.

The road ahead still held many difficult turns.

And soon, another chapter of her life would begin.

CHAPTER SEVEN

A New Beginning After the Storm



TIME PASSED SLOWLY.

The wounds in her heart did not disappear, but she had learned how to live with them.

She was no longer the same twelve-year-old girl who had returned to her father's home with tears in her eyes.

She had grown.

Not only in age,

but in understanding.

She had learned that life does not always follow the path we choose.

Sometimes, life takes away the people we love.

Sometimes, it breaks our hearts.

But sometimes, after every storm, it opens a new door.

Her family was always worried about her future.

They wanted her to have a life where she could feel safe again.

They wanted her to experience happiness after so much sadness.

Her father, who had always carried the responsibility of protecting his daughter, thought deeply about what would be best for her.

He did not want to make another decision that would bring pain into her life.

This time, he wanted her voice to be heard.

He wanted her heart to accept the path she would walk.

Because he had seen what happens when a person is forced into a life they are not ready for.

A while later, another marriage proposal came.

This time, everything was different.

She was older.

She understood life more.

She knew that marriage was not only about celebrations and beautiful clothes.

It was about companionship.

Respect.

Patience.

And sharing the difficulties of life together.

The young man who came into her life was a person with good character.

He respected her.

He knew about her past.

He knew the pain she had experienced.

And instead of judging her, he showed kindness.

Slowly, a feeling of trust began to grow in her heart.

She was afraid.

Because the heart that has been hurt once becomes careful.

But she also knew that she could not allow the pain of yesterday to destroy all the possibilities of tomorrow.

With the support of her family, she accepted a new beginning.

This time, she did not leave her father's home as an innocent child.

She left as a young woman who had learned many lessons from life.

She carried her memories with her.

She carried her losses.

She carried her hopes.

And she stepped toward a new chapter.

A chapter that would bring both happiness and challenges.

CHAPTER EIGHT

Building a Life With Patience



THE BEGINNING OF HER new life was not perfect.

No life is perfect.

Every home has its own difficulties.

Every family has its own tests.

But this time, she was not alone.

She had someone beside her who understood her.

Someone who knew that behind her silence were many untold stories.

Her husband tried to give her the feeling of safety that she had lost.

He respected her thoughts.

He valued her efforts.

And little by little, the fear inside her heart became smaller.

She learned again how to smile.

She learned again how to hope.

She learned that after losing something, it is still possible to find something beautiful.

Years passed.

Her home became filled with the sounds of children.

The same girl who had once lost her first child was now blessed with motherhood again.

But this time, she was older.

She was more experienced.

She understood the preciousness of every moment.

Every child became a piece of her heart.

Every smile became a reason to continue.

She gave her children the love she had always carried inside herself.

The love she had learned from her own mother.

The patience she had learned from her father.

And the strength she had gained from all the storms she had survived.

But life, once again, was preparing another test for her.

Because the story of a strong person is not a story without difficulties.

It is the story of someone who continues despite difficulties.

And her journey was not over yet.

CHAPTER NINE

The Weight of Responsibility



AS THE YEARS PASSED, she became more experienced in life.

She was no longer the young girl who was afraid of every unknown path.

She had become a woman who had learned how to face difficulties.

But motherhood brought a new kind of responsibility.

A responsibility that was both beautiful and heavy.

Her children looked at her with eyes full of trust.

To them, their mother was the safest place in the world.

When they were sick, they called her.

When they were afraid, they searched for her.

When they were happy, they wanted to share their happiness with her.

And she gave them everything she had.

Her time.

Her energy.

Her love.

Sometimes, when everyone was asleep at night, she would sit quietly and think about her life.

She remembered the little girl she once was.

The child who played in her father's yard.

The child who never imagined how many challenges were waiting ahead.

She looked at her children and wondered:

"Would they ever know how much their mother has endured for them?"

Perhaps they did not know.

Perhaps children do not understand their parents' sacrifices until they grow older.

But a mother's love does not wait to be understood.

A mother gives because her heart knows no other way.

She worked hard every day.

She managed the home.

She cared for her children.

She faced problems with patience.

There were days when she was exhausted.

Days when she wanted to cry.

Days when she wished someone would tell her:

"You have done enough. Now rest."

But she continued.

Because she was a mother.

And mothers often carry impossible burdens
with quiet strength.

CHAPTER TEN

The Hidden Tears of a Mother



PEOPLE OFTEN SEE A mother's smile.

They see her preparing food.

They see her caring for her children.

They see her standing beside her family.

But they do not always see the tears she hides.

They do not see the nights when she stays awake because she is worried.

They do not see the moments when she sacrifices her own wishes so her children can have a better life.

She had many hidden tears.

Many silent prayers.

Many moments when she spoke only to God about the pain inside her heart.

But every morning, when her children opened their eyes, she smiled.

Because she did not want them to carry her sadness.

She wanted them to feel safe.

She wanted them to grow up believing that the world could still be a kind place.

She knew what it felt like to lose childhood too soon.

That was why she tried to give her children the childhood she never fully had.

She allowed them to laugh.

To dream.

To hope.

She protected their hearts from the pain she had known.

But life always tests those who love deeply.

And once again, difficulties began to appear on her path.

New challenges.

New worries.

New moments that would require the same strength she had shown many times before.

But she had learned one important truth:

A person who has survived the darkest nights is no longer afraid of every shadow.

She had already faced storms.

And she was ready to face whatever came next.

CHAPTER ELEVEN

A Mother Who Hid Her Tears



YEARS PASSED SLOWLY.

She was no longer the little girl who had once entered her husband's home wearing colorful clothes and henna on her hands.

That child had now become a woman whom life had forced to grow up far too soon.

Her hands had become rougher.

Her eyes had witnessed many things.

But her heart was still the same kind and gentle heart she had carried since childhood.

She had become the mother of several children.

Each one of them was an entire world to her.

When one of her children became sick, her heart trembled.

When the sound of their laughter filled the house, all her tiredness disappeared for a moment.

Her children were the reason she continued moving forward.

But life had once again prepared a difficult test for her.

During those years, her father-in-law had grown old and weak, and he needed more care and attention.

She had to look after an elderly man as if he were a child.

Lifting him.

Washing his clothes.

Feeding him.

Taking care of all his needs.

Even the body of a young woman has its limits.

But she did not listen to her tired body.

She did not allow exhaustion to stop her.

Because there was one sentence always repeating in her mind:

"I must continue."

Many times, she lost the children she was waiting to welcome into this world.

Losses that are never just simple events for a mother.

Every child she lost took a piece of her heart with them.

But she did not even have the chance to grieve properly.

Because the next day, life demanded work from her again.

The sorrow that once again broke her heart was not only the grief of losing a father in a family;

it was the loss of a protector and a shelter for a child.

A sorrow that, three months after her second daughter was conceived, left her without her father.

This time, there was a broken child,
a woman without her support,
and a child who had always believed:

"My father will never leave me."

But she did not know that greater sorrows were still waiting for her.

The movie of her life was not finished yet.

She had learned how to cry without anyone knowing.

Sometimes at night, when everyone was asleep, she would quietly shed tears.

She lowered her voice,
because she did not want her children to wake up frightened.

But among all these hardships, there was a little girl in the house who had a special meaning for her.

Her first daughter.

The same child whose arrival had once brought light back into her mother's heart.

A beautiful, kind, and beloved daughter.

A daughter with whom her mother shared her deepest feelings.

This girl was not only her child.

She was a reminder of all the hopes that were still alive inside her heart.

When the mother looked at her, perhaps she imagined a beautiful future.

She thought:

"Maybe the hardships are finally over."

But life had written another story for her.

But life had written another story for her.

A story that would once again test her heart.

She did not know that the same daughter who had become the source of her hope would one day become the center of another great pain.

She did not know that a mother's heart is a strange thing.

It can survive its own pain,

but the pain of a child can break it in ways that nothing else can.

Every day, she worked harder.

She carried responsibilities that were heavier than her age and strength.

She was a mother.

A caregiver.

A daughter-in-law.

A woman who carried the worries of an entire family on her shoulders.

Many people saw her working.

Many people saw her patience.

But few people knew what was happening inside her heart.

They did not know about the nights when she silently asked God for strength.

They did not know about the tears she wiped away before anyone could see them.

They did not know how many times she had fallen inside, but stood up outside.

Because for her children, she had to remain strong.

She believed that a mother's pain should not become a burden on her children.

So she hid her tears.

She hid her exhaustion.

She hid the moments when her heart was tired.

And every morning, she wore a smile again.

Not because life had become easy,

but because love gave her the strength to continue.

Her children grew under the protection of that love.

They did not see all the sacrifices their mother made.

They only felt the warmth of her presence.

And perhaps this is the greatest secret of mothers:

They turn their own suffering into comfort for others.

They turn their own tears into smiles for their children.

They turn their tired hands into a shelter.

But even the strongest hearts have moments when they need someone to hold them.

And soon, another chapter of her life would begin.

A chapter that would bring a new test,

a new sorrow,

and another reason for her to prove how strong a mother's heart can be.

CHAPTER TWELVE

A Woman Who Stood Again With a Broken Heart



AFTER HER DAUGHTER LEFT, the house was no longer the same.

The same walls.

The same yard.

The same everyday sounds.

But something was missing.

The laughter of a child.

The sound of little footsteps.

The voice that once erased all of a mother's exhaustion.

Whenever the mother looked around the house, she saw a memory.

The place where her daughter used to sit.

The place where she used to play.

The place where she used to call:

"\...Mother."

But now, silence had taken the place of everything.

The grief of losing a child is not a grief that simply disappears.

A person only learns how to carry it and live with it.

Sometimes, even years later, when a mother hears her child's name, her heart feels the same pain it felt on the very first day.

But she was not allowed to remain trapped inside her sorrow.

Because there were still children who needed her hands.

There was still a home that needed to be cared for.

There was still an elderly father-in-law who needed her help.

She stood up again.

Not because her pain had ended,

but because her love for the children who remained was greater than her pain.

Years passed.

Life did not become easy.

But little by little, she learned how to live with hardships.

She understood that some battles cannot be won; they can only be crossed with courage.

Her father-in-law had lived with them for many years.

The woman who had once been hurt by him was now the person who had to care for him.

But the heart of this mother was not like the hearts of those who had caused her pain.

She decided not to carry the past with her.

Years later, when her mother-in-law returned weak and helpless, she was no longer the powerful woman she had once been.

She was a woman who had finally tasted loneliness and hardship herself.

Her eyes had grown weak.

Her body no longer had the strength it once had.

And perhaps, for the first time, she understood what she had done to another human being.

She looked at the mother of this story --- the same daughter-in-law she had treated harshly years before ---

and with a broken voice said:

"I was wrong."

"Forgive me."

Maybe forgiveness was not easy for everyone.

Maybe many people would say she had every right to remember all those wounds.

But the mother of this story chose another path.

She forgave.

Not because those pains were small,

but because she did not want her own heart to become filled with hatred.

Until the day her mother-in-law passed away, she cared for her.

The way one cares for a helpless human being.

And when that woman left this world, she left peacefully.

Perhaps, for the first time, without fear of the past.

After that, life became a little calmer.

The cruelty became less.

The humiliation became less.

Her husband, who had always been a good person in her heart, stood beside her more than before.

The economic struggles still existed.

But the darkness of the past years was no longer there.

Her children were growing older.

Her daughters became helpers to their mother.

Her sons were growing and building their futures.

The house that was once only a place of work and pain slowly began to regain the colors of life.

But life still had another lesson waiting for them.

Sometimes, when a person thinks the hardest days are finally over, destiny prepares another test.

Her eldest son, a talented young man, entered government work.

The family was happy.

The mother looked at him with pride.

For her, seeing her children succeed was the greatest reward life could give.

\...But after several years---

A false accusation.

A charge.

And once again, anxiety entered their home.

Her son went to prison.

The mother felt that old fear once again:

The feeling that their peaceful life was in danger.

But this time, there was one difference.

She was no longer that broken teenage girl.

She was a woman who had fallen many times and risen again every single time.

She looked at her children and told them:

"Never surrender to your circumstances."

"A person may lose many things in life, but they must never lose their hope."

And she did what she had done all her life:

She waited.

She prayed.

And she continued.

CHAPTER THIRTEEN

The Days When Peace Returned Again



LIFE HAD ENTERED ANOTHER difficult period for the family.

The home that had only recently begun to taste peace was once again filled with worry.

Every day, the mother waited for news about her son.

Every sound of the door, every ringing phone, every piece of news coming from outside made her heart tremble.

But this time, she was not the same woman she had been years before.

She was no longer the woman who once cried quietly in a corner of the house, while no one heard her voice.

Now, she was a mother who prayed for her children, gave them hope, and stood firmly for them.

The Goodbye She Could Not Say

In life, some pains come from losing someone you love.

But some pains are even heavier:

Losing someone you love without having the chance to say goodbye.

This kind of pain remains in a person's heart for years.

At that time, her son was in prison.

The walls between them were not only made of stone.

There were walls of distance, laws, and circumstances that a mother could not change.

Every day, she told herself:

"Be patient."

"One day he will return home again."

"One day I will hold my son in my arms again."

She lived with the hope of that day.

The hope of seeing him again.

The hope of the moment when she could hold his hand and say:

"Welcome home, my son."

But sometimes life brings news that the heart is not ready to hear.

That day, when the news arrived, everything stopped for her.

The sound of the world became distant.

Her breathing became heavy.

And her heart refused to accept that what she had heard was the truth.

She had lost her mother...

And her son had lost a piece of his soul.

She wanted to scream.

She wanted to cry.

She wanted to sit beside the one she had lost.

She wanted to hold her hand one last time and say:

"Mother, forgive me."

"I love you."

"Goodbye."

But she could not.

Her son was behind the walls of prison.

And the mother, outside those walls, was left alone with a broken heart.

She could not mourn the way her heart wanted.

She could not hold a ceremony.

She could not gather everyone who loved her.

She could not share her pain with others.

The world continued moving.

People continued with their daily lives.

But inside her heart, time had stopped.

That night, when everyone was asleep, she sat alone.

For years, she had been patient.

For years, she had hidden her pain.

But that night, her tears slowly began to fall.

Tears that no one saw.

She looked at the sky and quietly said:

"Forgive me."

"I wanted to be there."

"I wanted to be beside you in your final moments."

"I wanted to say goodbye."

Her pain was not only because she had lost her mother.

The greater pain was losing the chance to say the final goodbye.

A mother can endure many hardships.

She can endure poverty.

She can endure loneliness.

She can fight for years.

But a goodbye without a goodbye...

is a pain that no words can ever explain.

She carried that pain silently inside herself.

Like always.

She endured.

She continued.

She remained strong.

When her son finally learned about what had happened, he carried his own pain.

He knew his mother had endured this great sorrow alone.

He knew she had not been able to stand beside her own mother.

It became one of the deepest wounds in the story of their family.

A wound that perhaps would never completely heal.

But even in that difficult moment, the mother remained the same person she had always been.

She prayed.

Not with anger.

Not with hatred.

But with love.

She prayed:

"God, protect my son."

"Give him strength."

"Help him return home again."

Because even when her own heart was broken...
she was still a mother.

Her strength was not that she never felt pain.

Her strength was not that she never cried.

Her strength was that pain could not remove
love from her heart.

No one saw that goodbye.

No one counted those tears.

No one fully understood that sorrow.

But her heart remembered it until the end of her
life.

The goodbye she could not say.

The grief she could not reveal.

The pain she carried alone.

It was hard.

Very hard.



THE DAYS WHEN PEACE Returned Again
(continued)

But finally, that day arrived.

The day her son was released.

When he entered the house again, the mother only looked at him.

Perhaps there were thousands of words inside her heart.

But no words could show the love, fear, and concern of a mother as deeply as that look.

The house breathed again.

The family gathered together once more.

Her two daughters continued their studies and worked toward their futures.

They went to university.

They attended English courses.

Her younger sons were also on the path of learning and growth.

When the mother looked at them, perhaps she said in her heart:

"All those hardships were worth it, if you can have a better future."

But life never stays peaceful forever.

During those days when everyone thought the difficulties were finally over, a disagreement appeared among her children.

Once again, the mother found herself in a place that was familiar to her:

Between the pain of those she loved.

Between choices that no mother ever wishes to be forced to make.

She did not want any of her children to be hurt.

She did not want one person to be happy while another was broken.

A mother's heart had room for all of them.

For a while, one of her sons was sent to Iran so that the situation could become calmer.

During that time, the mother only prayed.

She no longer asked God for anything for herself.

Not wealth.

Not comfort.

She only wanted peace for her children.

After some time, her son returned.

Life slowly began moving toward calmer days again.

The family had grown.

A grandchild was born.

The sound of children filled the house once more.

And the mother thought perhaps God had finally gifted her a little peace after so many years of hardship.

But no one knew that one night, everything was going to change again.

That night, her second son---
the son she loved deeply,
a kind man,
an honest man,
a person who kept secrets,
someone who always understood his mother's heart---

returned home from his duty and the mosque.

But he did not get the chance to spend many more days with his family.

A heart attack...

and one moment that changed everything.

When the news arrived, the world became dark for the mother once again.

She could not believe it.

How was it possible?

Only a few days ago, she had heard his voice.

Only a few days ago, she had seen his smile.

How could a person simply disappear from this world in one moment?

That son was not only a child to his mother.

He was someone she could talk to.

Someone who knew her secrets.

Someone whose kindness felt like a shelter.

For the first time after many years, the mother wished for death.

Not because she was weak.

Not because she had lost her faith.

But because the pain of losing someone again had broken her heart.

She thought:

"God, how much more must I endure?"

Yet even in those darkest moments, something inside her refused to completely fall apart.

The same thing that had always been with her throughout her life:

Hope.

Her husband had grown old.

Many years had passed over his life.

But despite his weakness, he tried to comfort his wife and children.

A man who perhaps had not always been able to stand against every hardship, but who had always loved his wife in his heart.

Her eldest son also could not forgive himself.

He believed that the arguments and disagreements he had with his brother had caused this tragedy.

His grief and guilt made him sick.

He spent his days and nights in the cemetery.

Because he could not accept his brother's absence.

The house became filled with silence again.

But this time, the mother made a decision.

She could not change the past.

She could not bring back those she had lost.

But she could stay alive for those who were still beside her.

She looked at her children.

At her grandchildren.

At the little ones who still needed her love.

And once again, the same sentence came alive in her heart:

"I must continue."



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CHAPTER FOURTEEN

A Mother Who Rose Again From the Ashes



AFTER THE LOSS OF that son, the house was no longer the same.

Some people, when they leave, do not only leave an empty place behind; it feels as if they take a part of the lives of those who loved them with them.

There was no longer his laughter.

No longer his footsteps.

No one remained whom the mother could share her heart's secrets with.

No one remained who could calm her with just a simple sentence when she was tired.

The mother was going through difficult days.

But this time, there was one great difference.

She was no longer the twelve-year-old girl who did not know what to do when life brought its first pain.

She was a woman who had been broken dozens of times and had gathered herself together every single time.

A woman who had learned that life does not always move the way people wish.

But people can still choose how they face it.

She hid her grief.

Not because she had no pain.

Her pain was deeper than ever.

But she did not want her children to see her completely broken.

She did not want the house to be filled with hopelessness again.

So once again, she did what she had done all her life:

She placed her pain in God's hands and stood for her family.

She prayed more.

At night, when everyone was asleep, she quietly spoke with God.

She talked about the past.

She talked about the children she had lost.



A MOTHER WHO ROSE Again From the Ashes
(continued)

She spoke with God about the pain she had endured.

About the dreams she carried for her children.

She never asked God to change the past.

She knew that some events could never be reversed.

But she always prayed:

"God, show my children the right path."

"Keep them away from the pains I have suffered."

"Give them the strength to become good human beings."

During those days, the two children of her late son were beside her.

Children who were still very young.

They perhaps did not understand what had happened.

They did not know how much sorrow the woman sitting beside them carried in her heart.

But they knew one thing very well:

This woman loved them.

To the mother, those two children were not only memories of a loved one she had lost.

They were two new reasons to continue living.

When she looked at them, perhaps she felt that a part of her son's love was still remaining in this world.

But life was not only sadness.

Alongside the pain, there were also moments that kept hope alive.

Seeing her children grow.

Seeing their efforts.

Seeing each one of them trying to find a path toward building their future.

These things gave her strength.

Her third daughter also went through difficult days.

After seeing the struggles of the family, she made a decision about caring for her brother's two children that her heart was not completely ready for.

She thought perhaps by accepting a marriage, she could become a support for those children.

But later, she understood that a choice made only from sacrifice does not always bring a good result.

She did not want her mother's destiny to repeat itself.

She did not want to become a woman who spent years suffering and only enduring.

So, with her mother's help and support, she decided to choose another path.

A difficult path.

But a path that allowed her to find herself again.

The mother, even though she had spent her entire life being patient, taught her daughter an important lesson this time:

Patience does not mean accepting every injustice.

A person can be patient while still defending their own rights.

Slowly, things became better.

Her eldest son, who had struggled with emotional difficulties for a long time, found more peace again.

Her husband was still alive and beside her.

The home still had its own problems, but it no longer carried the darkness of the past years.

The mother looked back at her life.

At the girl who became a bride at the age of ten.

At the woman who became a mother at twelve and lost her child and husband.

At the mother who lost her eight-year-old daughter.

At the woman who worked for years, cried, forgave, and continued.

And perhaps if someone had asked her in those days:

"How are you still standing?"

Her answer would have been simple:

"Because there are still people who need me."

She had learned that sometimes being strong does not mean never crying.

Sometimes being strong means waking up in the morning with eyes full of tears.

Preparing bread.

Holding your child's hand.

Smiling.

And telling life:

"I am still here."

But this woman's story was not over yet.

Because her greatest wish throughout all those years was not something she wanted for herself.

She only wanted one day...

to see all her children successful and happy.

And the final chapters of her life continued with a great hope.



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CHAPTER FIFTEEN

A Mother Whose Wish Was Never For Herself



YEARS PASSED.

The girl who was once born in a small village, with tiny hands and a heart full of dreams, was now a mother who had given her entire life to others.

She was no longer searching for a way to make up for the past.

She knew that some wounds remain a part of a person forever.

But she had learned how to live with those wounds.

Every morning when she woke up, before anything else, she thought about her children.

Their future.

The path waiting ahead of them.

Whether life would be kinder to them or not.

She asked nothing from God for herself.

Not a large house.

Not great wealth.

Not a life without problems.

Because throughout her life, she had learned that the true value of life was found in other things:

In love.

In peace.

In seeing the smiles of the people you love.

Sometimes when she looked at her grandchildren, a gentle smile appeared on her face.

Children whose laughter brought life back into the house.

She looked at them and perhaps said in her heart:

"I hope you never experience the pain I have experienced."

She wished for her grandchildren to grow.

To study.

To succeed.

To become good people.

She wanted them to see a world where no child was forced to grow up before their time.

The mother always repeated one message to her children:

"Never surrender to your circumstances."

"If hardship comes, be patient."

"If someone hurts you, do not become someone who hurts others."

"Never empty your heart of kindness."

She had not learned these words only from books.

These were lessons she had lived with her entire being.



A MOTHER WHOSE WISH Was Never For Herself (continued)

She could not bring back the loved ones who had left this world.

But she could make sure that the pain of the past did not destroy the future.

She had decided that her past would not remain only a sad story.

She wanted her suffering to become a lesson for those who would live after her.

A lesson about hope.

About forgiveness.

About how a person can keep a small light burning even in the darkest moments.

If one day someone asked her:

"What was the greatest success of your life?"

Perhaps she would not say:

"Enduring all these hardships."

Perhaps she would not say:

"Surviving after all that pain."

Instead, she would say:

"That I was able to remain human."

Because hardships can change a person.

But she did not allow hardships to take away her kindness.

And now, the camera of life focuses again on her face.

A woman whose hair carries the signs of many years passing.

Hands that tell the story of hard work and struggle.

And eyes where hope is still alive.

She looks toward the future.

A future she may not see completely herself.

But she hopes her children will see it.

She hopes her grandchildren will see it.

She dreams of a day when:

No mother is forced to lose her child.

No child goes to sleep hungry.

No woman is deprived of the right to choose her own life because of traditions and customs.

No human being suffers because of another person's cruelty.

And perhaps this is her greatest dream:

To see a world where people love and care for one another more.

But the story still has one final image.

An image of a woman who spent her entire life fighting for others.

A woman whose name the world may never know...

But for her family,

she is a hero.



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CHAPTER SIXTEEN

The Hero No One Knew



SOME HEROES DO NOT wear special clothes.

Their names are not written in history books.

Their pictures are not placed on walls.

No one brings them medals.

But every day, without anyone seeing, they win a great battle.

The mother in this story was one of those heroes.

She never considered herself a hero.

When someone asked about the hardships of her life, perhaps she would simply say:

"Life is like this. You just have to endure."

But behind that simple sentence were decades of pain.

Years when a child was forced to grow up before her time.

Years when a young girl faced sorrows that even many adults could not endure.

Years when a mother was broken again and again, yet stood back up for her children every time.

Sometimes her children looked at their mother's hands.

Hands that were no longer as soft as they once were.

Hands that had lived for years with soil, water, fire, work, and hardship.

But those same hands...

were always the first hands to reach forward and give comfort.

She may not have had great wealth.

But she had something worth more than any treasure:

A heart that still had the ability to love.

Throughout her life, many people entered her story.

Some caused wounds.

Some offered help.

Some left and became memories.

But she learned not to define her life only by the actions of others.

She decided to choose for herself what kind of person she wanted to be.

After all the injustice she had experienced, she could have allowed her heart to become filled with anger.

She could have said:

"I should treat others the same way they treated me."

But she did not.

She chose another path.

The path of forgiveness.

The path of kindness.

The path of refusing to pass pain on to the next generation.

Perhaps her greatest victory was this:

Despite all the hardships, she did not become like those who had hurt her.



THE HERO NO ONE KNEW (continued)

Years later, when her children grew older, they slowly understood what price their mother had paid for the peace they enjoyed.

They understood that their mother's smiles did not always mean she had no pain.

Sometimes mothers smile because they do not want their children to carry the weight of their sorrow.

They understood that behind every prepared meal, there were hours of work.

Behind every clean piece of clothing, there was a mother's exhaustion.

Behind every prayer of a mother, there was the fear of losing another loved one.

But the mother never waited for thanks.

She had never treated these sacrifices as a transaction.

She was simply a mother.

And a mother's love is sometimes like a river;

it flows without waiting to receive anything in return.

One day, perhaps her children sat beside her and asked about the past.

About the days that no one had seen.

About the tears that no one had heard.

About the wounds that had remained hidden for years.

And the mother slowly began to tell her story.

Not to complain.

Not to blame anyone.

But to pass on one truth:

That a person can survive even the hardest days.

She said:

"Life is not always easy."

"People do not always treat you correctly."

"Sometimes you lose things that you think you cannot live without."

"But God always leaves a path for you to continue."

Her children listened to her words.

And perhaps for the first time, they understood that the woman sitting beside them was not only their mother.

She was a living history.

The history of a little girl from a village.

A girl whose childhood was short.

A woman whose youth passed through pain.
A mother who spent her entire life for others.
And now...

the camera of life slowly moves backward.

It shows the house.

The voices of children.

The voices of family.

The voice of life.

Among all these sounds, a woman sits.

A woman the world may not know.

But her family knows:

If today they are standing...

If today they still have hope...

If today they still understand love...

a part of it is because of the woman who kept the
light of the home burning for years.



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CHAPTER SEVENTEEN

The Light That Never Went Out



IT WAS A QUIET night.

The house was no longer the same house it had been in the distant years before.

The house where, once, the sound of crying and pain was louder than laughter was now filled with memories.

Every corner of that home carried a story.

The walls had witnessed the days when a young woman, with tired hands, held life together.

The yard remembered the footsteps of a woman who, years before, woke up before sunrise and worked until night for her family.

Sometimes the mother sat alone and thought about the past.

About the girl she once was.

About the mother she later became.

About all those who came and left.

About those who were still beside her.

She no longer ran away from her past.

Every memory that was once a fresh pain had now become a lesson.

She had learned that life is not only good days.

Life is a mixture of arrivals and departures.

Of smiles and tears.

Of falling and rising again.

Sometimes she looked at the sky and thought about the loved ones who were no longer beside her.

About the son whose laughter still lived in her mind.

About the daughter whose beautiful eyes once brightened the house.

About the brother who was her best friend in childhood.

About the first husband she lost too soon.

She missed them all.

But she no longer only cried.

Because she believed that human love does not end when people leave.

Some people leave our side, but they continue living inside our hearts.

She was still the same mother.

The same person who could not rest when a child was sick.

The same person whose heart could not be calm when one of her children was suffering.

But now, one thing had changed:

Her children were no longer small.

They could finally see their mother's pain.

They could finally understand what had been hidden behind all those years of silence.



THE LIGHT THAT NEVER Went Out (continued)

They understood that their mother had not only cooked their meals.

She had not only washed their clothes.

She had not only taken care of them.

She had given them her entire life.

Some mothers leave their children an inheritance of money and land.

But this mother left something far more valuable.

Her inheritance was hope.

Her inheritance was patience.

Her inheritance was humanity.

She always told her children:

"Being a good human being is more important than anything else."

"If you have money but break someone's heart, you are not successful."

"If you have a position and power but do not have honesty, you have nothing."

These words were not just advice for her.

They were the summary of her entire life.

She had seen how power, money, and status could change people.

But she had chosen to remain kind.

Days passed.

Her grandchildren grew older.

Every time one of them achieved something, a smile appeared on the mother's face.

For her, the success of her children and grandchildren was the greatest wealth.

She wished that one day she could sit and see all her children around her.

To see that they were healthy.

Happy.

And that they had found the right path in life.

Her wishes were never only for her own family.

She even prayed for people she did not know.

She would say:

"I wish no human being had to suffer."

"I wish no child was forced to grow up too soon."

"I wish no woman had to endure a life that breaks her heart."

This was what made her different.

Her own suffering had not made her heart smaller.

Instead, it had made her heart larger.

And perhaps this was the secret of her survival.

She kept hope alive.

Not only for herself.

But for everyone she loved.

Years ago, a little girl was born in a beautiful village.

No one knew how long and difficult the road ahead of her would be.

No one knew how many times she would fall.

No one knew how many times she would have to begin again.

But today, if someone hears her story, they understand one thing:

Some people do not simply live.

They light the way for others.

And this story...

is the story of a woman who, through the hardest nights of her life, never let a small light go out.

A light called:

Hope.



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CHAPTER EIGHTEEN

The Letter Written in Her Heart for Years



SOMETIMES PEOPLE CARRY WORDS in their hearts for an entire lifetime that they never get the chance to say.

Not because they have nothing to say,
but because they always think there will be another time.

But life teaches us that some words must be spoken.

Some love must be heard.

And some memories must be recorded so they are never forgotten.

If one day the mother could write her entire life in a letter, perhaps it would begin like this:

"To my children..."

"If one day you read these words, know that my entire life had only one wish:

That you would be happy."

"I may not have always been able to provide the best opportunities for you."

"I may not have always been beside you to solve every problem you faced."

"But I gave you every day of my life."

"I had a short childhood."

"I grew up too soon."

"I learned early that life is not always easy."

"But I never wanted you to suffer the same pains that I suffered."

"If one day you feel tired, do not lose hope."

"Remember that you had a mother who was broken many times, but stood up again."

"Not because she felt no pain."

"Not because she never cried."

"But because love was always stronger than pain."



THE LETTER WRITTEN IN Her Heart for Years
(continued)

"Never allow hardships to make your hearts cold.

People may hurt you.

They may ignore your rights.

But remain human.

Forgive, but do not accept injustice.

Be kind, but do not allow anyone to lower your value.

Be patient, but remember that patience does not mean staying silent in the face of unfairness.

Love one another.

Value your family."

"Because at the end of life, what remains is not the house and not the wealth.

What remains is the memory of the love we gave to one another."

"If one day I am no longer here, know that I was always proud of you.

Even when you made mistakes.

Even when you failed.

Because you were my children, and a mother's love has no conditions."

"I wish for you to succeed.

But more than success, I wish for you to remain good human beings.

Be people who understand the pain of others.

Be people who, if given power, use it to help, not to harm."

"I learned many things from life.

I learned that a person may lose many things, but they must never lose hope.

Because as long as there is hope, there is always a way to continue."

Perhaps the mother would never write such a letter on paper.

But she had written all these words through her life.

Through every morning when she woke up early.

Through every tear she hid.

Through every smile she created for her children.

And now the camera of life comes closer to her again.

A woman who fought for years.

A woman who lost many loved ones.

A woman who started over many times.

She still has dreams.

Simple dreams, but great ones.

She wants to see her children living in peace one day.

She wants her grandchildren to grow with success.

She wants no one in this world to experience the pain she experienced.

She does not want her name written somewhere grand.

She does not want anyone to build a statue for her.

She only wants the people she loves to know:

A woman spent her entire life loving them so they could have a better life.

And perhaps the most beautiful sentence that can be said about her is:

She did not have an easy life.

But she never allowed life to take away her humanity.



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CHAPTER NINETEEN

The Days When She Saw the Fruits of Patience



YEARS PASSED SLOWLY BESIDE her.

The woman who once thought she might never experience peace again now sometimes had moments when she sat quietly and looked back

at the long road she had traveled.

A long road.

Full of twists and turns.

Full of tears.

But a road that had left something precious behind:

Children who had grown with love.

She still remembered the pains of the past.

Some nights, she dreamed of loved ones she had lost many years before.

When she woke in the morning, she remained silent for a few moments.

As if she was caught between the past and the present.

But then the voices of her children and grandchildren brought her back to life.

She understood that life is not only about the things we lose.

Sometimes, we must also look at the things we built despite all the hardships.

She had lost her childhood.

She had lost her youth.

She had lost many years of peace.

But in return, she had raised human beings whose hearts were filled with kindness.

Her children slowly grew older.

Each one found their own path.

Some continued their education.

Some worked to build their future.

Some accepted the responsibilities of life.

And the mother watched them from a distance.

Not with pride in what she herself had done,

but with gratitude that God had given her the strength to continue.

Every success her children achieved felt like a gift to her.



THE DAYS WHEN SHE Saw the Fruits of Patience
(continued)

She knew that life would never remain easy forever.

No generation lives without difficulties.

That is why she always reminded her children:

"If hardship comes one day, remember that no dark night lasts forever."

She wanted them to understand something that she had learned with her entire being:

A strong person is not someone who never falls.

A strong person is someone who rises again after falling.

One day, one of her children asked her:

"Mother, how were you able to endure so much pain?"

She remained silent for a moment.

Perhaps all the memories of those years passed before her eyes.

Then she quietly said:

"I did not endure everything all at once. I simply lived each day as it came."

Those words were simple.

But behind them was a lifetime of experience.

She did not know how to carry the entire future.

She did not know how to face every sorrow waiting ahead.

She only woke up every morning and did what needed to be done.

And that was the secret of how she continued.

The mother never saw herself only as a victim.

Even though she had suffered greatly, she did not define herself only by her pain.

She said:

"I am not only someone who has suffered hardship.

I am someone who has passed through hardship."

That difference was enormous.

Some people allow their pain to become their entire identity.

But she never allowed that.

She was a mother.

She was a friend.

She was a shelter for others.

She was a woman who, despite all her wounds, still had the ability to give love.

Years later, when her grandchildren grew older, they began to understand her story more deeply.

They understood that the grandmother who always seemed calm had survived many storms.

They understood that her smile was not the result of an easy life.

It was the result of a long battle.

They learned that some people do not become heroes through great words.

They become heroes through small and continuous actions.

Through every morning they wake up.

Through every time they forgive.

Through every time they choose hope.

And the mother in this story...

did one thing throughout her entire life:

She never allowed the light of hope to go out.

Not when her childhood ended.

Not when she lost the loves of her life.

Not when her heart was broken.

Not when she thought she no longer had the strength to continue.

She always found a reason to go on.

Sometimes it was a child.

Sometimes a son or daughter.

Sometimes a grandchild.

And sometimes only a small belief inside her heart:

"Tomorrow may be better."

CHAPTER TWENTY

A Mother's Last Wish



YEARS PASSED.

Her hair became whiter.

The hands that once worked from morning until night had now become slower.

But her heart was still the same heart as the years of her youth

A heart that beat for others.

Sometimes, when she sat alone, she thought about the entire path she had traveled.

About the day she was born in a green village.

About the childhood that was filled with peace.

About the girl who thought that happiness would always continue.

About the woman who suddenly faced the hardships of life.

She had learned that nothing in life is forever.

Not happiness.

Not sadness.

Not hardships.

But what can remain forever is the impact a person leaves in the hearts of others.

She may not have built great houses.

She may not have collected a lot of wealth.

But she had built a family.

A family that was shaped by her love, patience, and sacrifice.

Sometimes she looked at her children and said to herself:

"Did I manage to do what I was supposed to do?"

And the answer in her heart was always one thing:

"Yes."

Because she had given everything she had.

She no longer looked at the past with regret.

The past was painful.

Very painful.

But those same pains had built her.

Those same difficult days had taught her how strong a person can become.

She had learned a great lesson from life:

No one can stop all the storms of life.

But a person can learn how not to lose themselves while standing in the middle of the storm.

She looked at her children and always had one wish:

That they would walk a path filled with peace.

That they would not have to experience the same pains that she had experienced.

That when they looked back at their past, they would have more smiles than tears.

She wished for her daughters:

That they would always know their own worth.

That no one would be able to make them feel small.

That they would know being a woman does not mean accepting everything.

For her sons, she wished:

That they would be kind men.

Men who used their strength to support their families, not to break the hearts of others.

Men who understood that kindness is the greatest sign of being human.

For her grandchildren, she wished:

That they would see the world better than the way she had seen it.

That they would have dreams freely.

That they would study.

That they would succeed.

That they would never lose their hope.

And for all the people of the world, she had one wish:

That no human being would experience the pain of another.

That no child would be forced to lose their childhood.

That no mother would be forced to send her child away with tears.

She did not know how much time the future would give her.

But she knew she would hold onto one thing until her final moment:

Hope.

Because her entire life had proven this:

A person may lose many things\...

But as long as they have hope, there is still something to continue for.

The camera of life slowly moves away from her.

A woman is sitting among her family.

Her face is full of the signs of years of life.

Every line on her face has a story.

Every silence carries a memory.

Every smile is a victory.

She is the same little girl who was once born in a beautiful village.

The same girl who no one knew what path was waiting ahead for her.

The same woman who broke many times,
but stood up again every time.

And now the name of her life story shines brighter than ever:

"The Woman Who Held Onto Hope"

\...To be continued.

CHAPTER TWENTY-ONE

The Legacy That Remained From a Kind Heart



SHE KNEW THAT LIFE would not always remain easy.

No generation lives without problems.

That is why she always reminded her children:

"If one day hardship comes, remember that no dark night lasts forever."

She wanted them to understand something that she herself had understood with her whole being:

A strong person is not someone who never falls.

A strong person is someone who rises again after falling.

One day, one of her children asked her:

"Mother, how were you able to endure all this pain?"

She remained silent for a moment.

Perhaps all the memories of those years passed before her eyes.

Then she quietly said:

"... I did not endure everything. I only lived each day as much as that day required."

This sentence was simple,

but behind it, a lifetime of experience was hidden.

She did not know how to endure the entire future.

She did not know how to face all the coming sadness.

She only woke up every morning and did what she had to do.

And that was the secret of her continuing.

The mother never considered herself a victim.

Although she had suffered many hardships, she did not define herself only by her pains.

She said:

"I am not only someone who has seen hardship. I am someone who has passed through hardships."

This was a big difference.

Some people allow their pains to become their entire identity.

But she did not allow that.

She was a mother.

She was a friend.

She was a shelter.

She was a woman who, despite all her wounds, could still give love.

Years later, when her grandchildren grew older, perhaps one day they understood her life story better.

They understood what storms the grandmother who was always calm had survived.

They understood that her smile was not the result of an easy life.

It was the result of a long battle.

They learned that some people do not become heroes through big words.

They become heroes through small and continuous actions.

Through every morning they wake up.

Through every time they forgive.

Through every time they choose hope.

\...And the mother of our story

did one thing throughout her entire life:

She did not let the lamp of hope go out.

Not when her childhood ended.

Not when she lost the loves of her life.

Not when her heart was broken.

Not when she thought she no longer had the strength to continue.

She always found a reason to go on.

ادامه:

Sometimes a child.

Sometimes a son.

Sometimes a grandchild.

And sometimes only a small belief in her heart:

"Tomorrow may be better."

\...To be continued.

CHAPTER TWENTY-TWO

When a Mother's Story Reached the Next



GENERATION

Time had passed.

Many things had changed.

The houses had changed.

People had grown older.

The children who once ran in the yard with their little feet had now built their own lives and families.

But one thing had not changed:

The mother's love, the mother who years ago had given everything she had for them.

Sometimes her children gathered around her.

Each one had a memory from the past.

One remembered how their mother stayed awake beside them at night.

Another remembered how their mother always thought of others before herself.

Another remembered that when they made mistakes, instead of breaking their hearts, their mother showed them the right path.

Now they understood that the things which seemed ordinary in childhood were actually great sacrifices.

When food was ready, they did not know that hours of work were behind it.

When they wore clean clothes, they did not know that tired hands had worked hard for them.

When they felt safe, they did not know that a mother had spent nights praying with worry for their future.

The mother never reminded anyone of these things.

She never said:

"What did I do for you?"

Because true love does not keep accounts.

She had given because she loved.

But now it was time for her children to understand.

To understand that a person can appear calm, while carrying a great story inside.

When she spoke about those days, she smiled, because despite everything that happened later, she did not want to forget the beautiful memories of her childhood.

She knew that life was not only pain.

Alongside bitterness, there are also sweet moments.

She wanted her children to always remember one thing:

"Do not forget the past, but do not live in the past.

Learn from your wounds, but do not allow your wounds to turn you into another person."

Years ago, a little girl thought that the peace of her father's home would continue forever.

Then life showed her that everything changes.

But she also showed life that a kind heart can pass through every change.

Now, when she looked into the mirror, she saw a woman whose face carried the signs of years of effort.

But in her eyes, that same little girl could still be seen.

The same girl who loved.

The same girl who hoped.

The same girl who still believed that goodness has value.

And perhaps the most beautiful part of her story was this:

Life tried many times to take hope away from her.

But every time, she found hope again.

\...To be continued.

CHAPTER TWENTY-THREE

The Woman Whose Prayer Was Greater Than Herself



YEARS PASSED, AND THE mother looked at life more calmly than ever.

She no longer hurried to prove herself to anyone.

She had spent years trying to make others understand who she was.

But now she understood that a person's value is not decided by what people say.

A person's value is shown through their heart, their actions, and the impact they leave in the lives of others.

Sometimes in the mornings, when the sunlight gently entered the house, the mother would stand by the window for a few moments.

She looked at the sky.

And in her heart, she thanked God.

Not because life had become free of pain,
but because despite all the pain, she still had people to love.

She had lost many loved ones.

People who, if they were still alive, perhaps would sit beside her today and remember the past together.

But the mother had learned to live with empty places too.

She had learned that love does not always mean physical presence.

Sometimes someone leaves, but their love remains in our hearts.

She had learned to pray sometimes for those she had lost.

For the child whose growing up she could not see.

For the daughter who left this world too soon.

For the son whose absence was never filled.

For the brother who was her first friend in life.

But after praying, she turned her eyes toward those who were still beside her.

Because she knew that life, despite all the losses, still has gifts.

The mother no longer had great wishes for herself.

She never said:

"I wish I had this."

"I wish my life had been different."

Maybe sometimes her heart became heavy.

Maybe sometimes she thought about the past.

But in the end, she always had one sentence:

"Thank God that my children are here."

For her, happiness had found another meaning.

Happiness meant seeing a child's smile.

It meant hearing the news of the success of someone you love.

It meant knowing there are people who, if you fall, will hold your hand.

From her children, she wanted only one thing:

That they would be good human beings.

Not only that they become wealthy.

Not only that they gain a social position.

But that when someone needed them, their hearts would not be closed.

She said:

"The world does not need many people with power; it needs many people with kind hearts."

Maybe she did not have many things in life.

But she had something that many wealthy people do not have:

The peace of knowing that she had done all her efforts for the people she loved.

One day, when her grandchildren were around her, she looked at them.

The children who were the hope of her future.

She held their small hands.

And she smiled.

Maybe at that moment, all the years that had passed went before her eyes:

From the green village of her childhood.

From her kind father.

From the bitter days of her youth.

From the nights when she cried.

From the mornings when she stood up again.

And perhaps in her heart she said:

"I did not lose everything."

"I kept love."

Because in the end, what remains from a person is not the number of years they lived.

Nor is it the number of pains they endured.

It is the impact they left in the hearts of others.

\...And the mother of our story

left a great impact throughout her entire life:

She taught her children that even when the world becomes difficult, it is still possible to remain human.

CHAPTER TWENTY-FIVE

What the Mother Left Behind



ONE DAY WILL COME when people will no longer remember only our names.

They will remember how they felt when they were with us.

Did they feel safe with us?

Did we hold their hands during hardships?

Did we make the world a little kinder for them?

The mother of our story may not have known that throughout all these years, she had slowly built a great legacy.

Not a legacy of gold, houses, and wealth.

Not a legacy of gold, houses, and wealth.

A legacy of values.

Of patience.

Of honesty.

Of kindness.

Of hope.

She did not only teach her children the way to live.

She taught them the way to be human.

She taught them:

If someone is weaker than you, do not make them feel small.

If someone makes a mistake, treat them with mercy.

If you gain power, use it to support others.

Maybe she herself, as a child, did not know that one day she would become such a mother.

Maybe that little girl who felt like a queen in her father's arms could never imagine what days were waiting for her.

But life slowly shaped her.

Every tear became a lesson.

Every failure became an experience.

Every loss made her heart deeper.

She had learned that some wounds cannot be erased.

But something can be done:

Those wounds can become a reason to be kinder.

When the mother looked back at the past, there were perhaps moments when her heart became heavy.

Maybe she wished some things had never happened.

She wished more children had remained in her arms.

She wished her loved ones were still beside her.

She wished some people had made better choices.

But beside all those wishes, there was one great truth:

She was still standing.

And that standing was her greatest answer to all the hardships.

Life had tried many times to break her.

But every time, from those same broken pieces, she built something new.

Her children now understood better why their mother always said:

"Do not break someone's heart."

Because she herself had tasted the pain of a broken heart.

They understood why she said:

"Do not lie."

Because she knew how valuable trust was.

They understood why she said:

"Do not wrong anyone."

Because she herself had spent years living with the pain of injustice.

She did not want her children to take revenge for the past.

She wanted them to make the past better.

One generation can pass pain to the next generation.

But one aware person can stop this chain.

And the mother of this story was the one who said:

"My pain should not become your pain."

She raised her children with love instead of raising them with hatred.

Instead of saying:

"The world is bad, do not trust anyone."

She said:

"Be good, but be wise."

CHAPTER TWENTY-SIX

The Day Everyone Understood



IT TOOK YEARS FOR everyone to understand what the mother's silences truly meant.

In her younger years, many people only saw a calm woman.

A woman who did not talk much.

A woman who did not complain.

A woman who, even when she was tired, still continued doing her duties.

But no one knew what a great story was hidden behind that silence.

Sometimes, when people see a great tree, they only see its shade.

They do not see how many years that tree stood under the sun and rain.

They do not see how many storms passed beside it.

They do not see how deep its roots became so that it could stand strong today.

The mother was like that tree.

Everyone saw the peace she had today.

But no one had seen all the storms of her past.

When her children grew older, they slowly began asking the questions that had remained in their minds for years.

They asked:

"Mother, how were you able to do it?"

"How did you still smile after all those events?"

"How did you still pray for others?"

The mother stayed silent for a moment.

She had never explained much about herself.

But that day, perhaps she felt it was time for her children to know.

Not so that she could blame anyone.

Not so that she could show someone as guilty.

But so that they would know life is not always what it looks like from the outside.

She said:

"I also had days when I thought I could not continue."

"I also cried."

"I also became tired."

"I also wished someone would hold my hand."

"But every time I thought it was over, I found a reason to continue."

"Sometimes it was a child."

"Sometimes it was a small smile."

"Sometimes it was only a prayer."

Her children listened quietly.

For the first time, they were not only seeing their mother;

they were seeing the little girl she once had been.

A girl who had dreams.

A girl who had fears.

A girl who had suffered pain.

CHAPTER TWENTY-SEVEN

The Camera of Life



IF ONE DAY A camera could show her entire life from the beginning until today, perhaps the first image it would show would be a small house surrounded by nature.

A little girl running in the yard with her innocent childhood laughter.

A girl who still did not know that the world would not always remain peaceful.

A girl who, whenever her father returned home, would run toward him, throw herself into his arms, and at that very moment feel that she had

found the safest place in the world.

The camera moves forward.

A kind father appears.

A calm and caring mother.

A home filled with love.

A girl who learns patience, honesty, and humanity from her parents.

No one knows that this little girl will one day walk through such a difficult path.

The image changes.

The same little girl is now a child who still has childhood dreams.

Beautiful clothes.

Celebrations.

Laughter.

She still does not know that some of the biggest decisions are made for children who have not yet had the chance to truly be children.

The camera moves slowly.

A little girl wearing a wedding dress.

Henna-covered hands.

A peaceful face.

Everyone around her is happy.

But one brother stands in a corner and cries.

Because perhaps he is the only one who understands that this child is not yet ready for all these changes.

The image changes again.

A ten-year-old girl who has entered a new home.

A home that is unfamiliar to her at first.

But her husband's kindness reduces some of her fear.

She is still a child.

She still sees the world as something simple.

\...But then

Life shows another face.

Losing a child.

Losing a husband.

Loneliness.

Pressure.

Difficult choices.

A girl who should still have been playing is now forced to face the heaviest pains of life.

The camera shows her returning to her father's house.

The same house she once left with happiness.

But now she is no longer the same child she was before.

Her eyes have seen things that no child should ever have to see.

Then the image of a father appears, a father who embraces his daughter with all his strength.

A father who wants to tell her:

"You are still too young for all this pain."

But he also knows that some pains cannot be taken away from a person.

One can only stay beside them.

The camera moves forward.

A girl who is forced to make another great decision.

This time to protect her own peace.

To protect her future.

To avoid continuing a life filled with a pain she never chose.

Many years passed before she understood:

Perhaps she could not build her own life exactly the way she wanted.

But she was able to make the lives of those she loved better.

And for a mother, this is the greatest victory.

She looked back.

At the little girl she once was.

At the woman she became.

At the mother who gave her entire life away.

And she quietly said:

"I did not lose everything."

Because she could still hear the laughter of her children.

She could still hold the hands of her grandchildren.

There were still people who felt peace when they

saw her.

And perhaps one day, when she no longer had the strength to tell her own story,

her life's book would remain in the hands of those who would know:

An ordinary woman can also have an extraordinary life.

Not because the world was easy on her,

but because she did not surrender to the world.

This book is not only about the suffering of a woman.

It is about the hope that did not fade even on the darkest days.

It is about a love that remained despite all the wounds.

It is about a mother who showed that:

Sometimes one person can be the reason an entire family keeps going.

Dedicated to my mother;

The woman who held on to hope.

I ask everyone who reads this book to read it with their heart.

Perhaps within these pages, they will find a part of their own life.

Perhaps they will remember someone who was once a source of hope for them.

I hope this story carries a message for those who are going through difficult days:

No night remains dark forever.

No wound can destroy all the beauty of a heart.

And as long as hope is alive, there is always a way to keep going.

With respect and love



Acknowledgment

FIRST, I THANK GOD;

For all the moments when He gave me the strength to continue through hardships,

For the hope He keeps alive within people's hearts,

And for the strength He gives us to overcome difficult days.

With all my heart, I am grateful to the mother who became the inspiration for this story.

To the woman who endured so much pain, but never allowed pain to take away her kindness.

To the mother who hid many of her tears so she could gift her family a smile.

To the heart that was broken, yet still had the ability to love.

I thank my family; for the memories, companionship, and love that gave meaning to this story.

I am grateful to the children and generations who are continuing this mother's path; because a person's values remain alive when they continue in the hearts of others.

I thank everyone who accompanied me on the journey of bringing this book to life with their patience, love, and support.

This book respectfully remembers all the mothers who have fought in silence, and all those who have endured hardships yet still held on to hope.

And finally, I thank the dear readers who gave their time and their hearts to this story.

I hope this book is not merely a few pages of writing; but rather, a reminder that love, sacrifice, and kindness never disappear.

Some people remain alive even after they are gone;

In memories,

In prayers,

And in the hearts of those who loved them.

With gratitude and respect,

The Author

Nazdana Noorzai